



Muhlenberg College Emergency Medical Services Mass Casualty Incident Drill “FAQs”

What is occurring, and why?

On April 14, 2024, from 10:30 am to 1 pm, Muhlenberg College EMS will be conducting a Mass Casualty Incident (MCI) drill. This drill is a training exercise designed to prepare our agency for the worst-case scenario, one in which the number of patients outnumbers the amount of resources that we have available. Within emergency management, there are two main segments: mitigation and preparedness. Though we do our best to ensure that large-scale emergencies do not happen, it remains imperative that first-response agencies thoroughly prepare for these emergencies.

What does this mean for me?

This drill will take place in Moyer Hall and the areas immediately around it. You can expect the building and the nearby walkways to be closed off for the duration of the drill. Please avoid the area to prevent interference.

What can I expect to occur?

Though the details of the scenario will not be released, there are a few expectations that we can share. Firstly, though there is likely to be a lot of “action” near Moyer, you can expect several emergency vehicles to be present, both MCEMS and Campus Safety, in addition to our neighboring agencies of Allentown EMS and Fire. Though there will be lots of “action,” there is no danger to the campus community. Additionally, no emergency alerts will be sent out to the campus, and no “Shelter in Place” will be issued.

What can I expect to see?

On the day of the drill, you can expect to see a lot of individuals moving around campus in emergency vehicles and in emergency uniforms. There will be a lot of radio communication and a large crowd gathered near Moyer Hall. You may see people yelling and screaming for help, and what appears to be blood on individuals. This blood is not real and only makeup. The individuals screaming and crying are patient actors who are only pretending to be injured for the sake of the authenticity of the drill. We will have medical staff on standby in the event that anyone is in need of medical assistance during the drill. Additionally, no weapons will be present at the drill.

Who is in Charge?

This drill is being run by Muhlenberg College Emergency Medical Services, with support from campus safety, senior staff, and multiple Lehigh Valley emergency response organizations.

Who can I contact if I have questions/concerns?

If you or someone you know is feeling anxious about what has occurred before, during, or after the drill, the counseling center is prepared and available to help. Situations like these affect us all differently, and it is crucial that we seek assistance when it is needed.

For questions about the drill itself, you can contact MCEMS (bergems@muhlenberg.edu), Campus Safety (Non-Emergency: 484-664-3112), or Dean William's office (deanofstudents@muhlenberg.edu).

What does this mean for the campus?

This drill serves to help the campus assess and better prepare for any mass casualty incident that could occur. Practicing and assessing the effectiveness of our response in these situations will create a safer environment for Muhlenberg.